



Hibernate

Hibernate is no longer available in Ubuntu 12.04 by default, you can use Suspend instead. But if you're a purist and want your good ol' hibernate button back use the following command. But before we move on, a valid and a necessary question will arise in your mind which being what is the exact difference between 'suspend' and 'hibernate'? Hibernate powers everything down and stores the entire content of the RAM in the hard disk, thus it saves a lot of power which is important for laptops and netbooks. Suspend powers down everything except RAM and it still consumes power. Before going all out and enabling hibernating, first you must ascertain whether your computer supports hibernate or not you can do this by running the following command

```
sudo pm-hibernate
```

Your computer will shut-down after this. When you turn it back on, you should get back all the applications back as they are. If this is successful, it means your computer supports hibernate. Now go ahead and run the following command

```
gksu gedit /etc/polkit-1/localauthority/50-local.d/com.ubuntu.enable-hibernate.pkla
```

Add the following lines to the file that just opened

```
[Re-enable hibernate by default]
Identity=unix-user:*
Action=org.freedesktop.upower.hibernate
ResultActive=yes
```

Save the file and exit. Now log off and log back in. The power menu should now start showing the "Hibernate" option.

Restricted packages

Ubuntu ships only with completely free software by default that means certain proprietary media codecs will not work out-of-box. Ubuntu does and

can play most of the proprietary media formats out there like DVD, MP3, Quicktime and many more. To enable the media formats use the following command in your terminal or search for 'restricted' in the Ubuntu Software Center.

```
sudo apt-get install ubuntu-restricted-extras
```

GIMP 2.8

Gimp 2.8 is out and about, that too after three very long years of hard work. It includes many new features including some which were highly requested by the community. Here are a few tips and tricks which will make your life with Gimp easier.

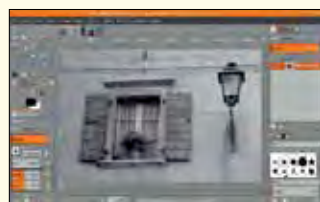
Installing Gimp 2.8

Compiling Gimp is a real pain in the behind. The dependencies will keep you reeling and they keep on coming in droves. A better way is to use an unofficial Gimp 2.8 PPA which will make installing Gimp in Ubuntu a breeze. Run the following commands in the terminal:

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:otto-kesselgulasch/gimp
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install gimp
```

Single window!

If you had opened the previous versions of Gimp, you would've seen all the panels as separate windows on the screen. Perhaps the most requested feature on the community. You can toggle the single window feature by checking the Single-window checkbox in the Windows menu.



Gimp 2.8 comes with a single-window feature

Save and Export

Perhaps the most radical changes of all, you can now only save files in Gimp's native XCF format, which will save all the extra information about the work in progress. To export and in essence save the image in different format you'll have to export the image using the Export command which can be accessed from File->Export... One of the main benefits of this separation of concerns is that all those annoying pop-ups which came when saving in a different format have been got ridden off.

Layer Groups

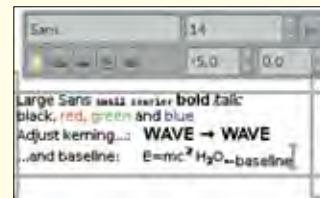
It used to be excruciating to handle a file with anything more than 100 layers in earlier versions of Gimp. Layer groups are something that we take for granted in Photoshop, this feature is introduced in this version. You can now group layers which organize the layers in a tree like structure. The best part is that the Layer Groups can be accessed through the Gimp API and used to code plugins.

On-canvas Text Editing

Perhaps the best possible enhancement, this is something that was absolutely needed. Earlier users had to type the text in a separate window, applying effects and then hit apply to see the changes on the canvas. With this version of Gimp, you can edit the text directly on the canvas itself. And boy, does it work well or what: apart from the usual editing features in other image editing programs (read, Photoshop) like font family, size and style you also get the ability to use a combination of Alt and arrow keys to change the baseline and kerning of the font.

Maths in Gimp

A very nifty addition this when making objects on the canvas

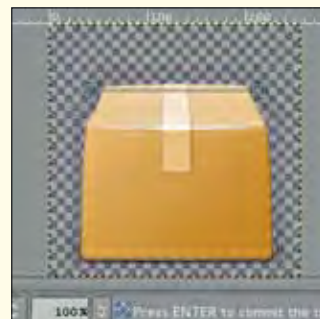


You can now organize layers into groups

using the size entry widget to input the values of x, y, width and height. You can now use math equations here, very logical and straightforward. For example, in the scale dialog it is now possible to write '50%' in the Width field to scale the image to 50% of the width. Expressions such as '30in + 40px' and '4 * 5.4in' work, too.

Cage Transform

An innovative approach to free transformation this tool was devel-



Cage Transform in action

oped during the Google Summer of Code 2010. The tool makes it possible to easily warp parts of objects using an adjustable user-defined polygonal frame.

A few others that deserve a mentions

You can now directly align text to a path through the context menu. You can now export your palette for CSS, PHP, Python, txt and Java, this can be accessed through the palette context menu. GIMP 2.8 also further enhances its scripting abilities. For example, API changes to support layer groups have been made. The API has been refactored to make it easy to develop new scripts. 